

Alejandro Gómez Salgado

Senior Software Engineer | Backend & Distributed Systems | Product-Focused Engineering

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Professional Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 20+ years of experience building reliable, scalable backend systems and enterprise software platforms across fintech, retail pricing, payments, digital identity, compliance-driven workflows, and AI-enabled products. Strong experience designing distributed systems, APIs, event-driven services, and data-intensive processing using Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, and relational databases. Experienced owning end-to-end backend workflows, integrating internal and external systems, and delivering observable, resilient solutions in collaboration with product, analytics, and cross-functional engineering teams. Proven track record building systems where consistency, traceability, validation, and operational integrity are critical. Combines hands-on software engineering with technical leadership, mentoring, and a strong product mindset to solve complex operational and customer-facing problems at scale.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java (8/11/17), Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Pro*C

Frameworks: Spring Boot (MVC, Data, Security), Hibernate, JPA, Apache Spark

Backend & Distributed Systems: Microservices, RESTful API Design, Kafka, Event-Driven Architecture, Workflow Orchestration, ETL Processing, Async Processing, Batch Processing

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Oracle Database, IBM DB2, Azure Cosmos DB, SQL Optimization, Query Performance Tuning

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, Rancher, Helm, Harness, GitHub Actions, CI/CD Pipelines

Testing & Quality: JUnit, Mockito, WireMock, Postman, Integration Testing, API Testing

Monitoring & Security: Dynatrace, Runtime Diagnostics, JWT, Spring Security, Auth0, OAuth 2.0

Professional Experience

Senior Backend Software Engineer

Tech Mahindra — Kroger — Remote

July 2024 – May 2026

Built and maintained enterprise backend platforms supporting pricing optimization, rule validation, and operational workflows across Kroger store divisions. Focused on delivering scalable and reliable systems where consistency, traceability, and auditability were essential for business operations.

- Developed Spring Boot microservices and REST APIs supporting pricing configuration, validation, and operational workflows across multiple store divisions
- Built and maintained end-to-end integrations between internal pricing systems, ETL pipelines, and downstream platform consumers
- Contributed to the Unified Pricing Engine POC using Drools to enable transparent, configurable, and auditable rule execution
- Improved service reliability and observability through SQL performance optimization, monitoring, and proactive production support
- Supported migration from Enterprise Kafka to Kafka as a Service (KaaS), simplifying shared infrastructure and improving maintainability
- Led dependency analysis and rollout for the decommissioning of legacy pricing services
- Collaborated closely with product, QA, ETL, and platform teams to deliver scalable, reliable backend services for business-critical workflows

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, Drools, PostgreSQL, IBM DB2, Azure Cosmos DB, Kubernetes, Rancher, Helm, Harness, Dynatrace

Technical Lead / Architect

Baufest — Lynk (Digital Wallet of Bank of Jamaica) / Innovation Lab — Remote

March 2022 – April 2024

Worked across fintech and innovation initiatives, building backend platforms for digital wallet operations, identity verification, compliance-sensitive workflows, and enterprise AI experimentation. Provided technical leadership across implementation teams, ensuring architecture validation and engineering execution.

- Developed backend microservices using Java and Spring Boot to support core financial workflows
- Implemented secure authentication and remittance APIs for digital wallet operations and money movement

- Integrated Auth0 and OnFido for identity verification, onboarding, and compliance-related verification workflows
- Built event-driven services using Kafka and webhooks for asynchronous backend processing
- Designed backend systems supporting validation, traceability, and operational integrity across customer-facing flows
- Contributed to the architecture of an enterprise LLM-based platform utilizing Azure AI and OpenAI
- Designed benchmarking strategies for AI experimentation, focusing on prompt engineering, embeddings, and semantic retrieval
- Evaluated emerging technologies to guide engineering decisions and roadmap planning
- Mentored engineers through code reviews, technical planning, career development, and architecture discussions

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Auth0, OnFido, Python, Azure AI, OpenAI APIs, Angular

Software Consultant / Product Owner / Service Delivery Manager

Equifax / Inffinix Software — Mexico City / Dublin — Hybrid

July 2004 – March 2022

Evolved enterprise software platforms supporting large-scale Collections & Recoveries operations globally. Managed business-critical systems responsible for workflow orchestration, financial processing, compliance-driven operational execution, and large-scale modernization efforts.

- Designed and developed enterprise backend systems supporting complex international Collections & Recoveries workflows
- Led modernization initiatives migrating legacy Pro*C batch processing to Java and Apache Spark
- Transformed legacy platform behaviors into scalable modern architectures to improve maintainability and long-term reliability
- Created technical and functional documentation to guide modernization efforts across global teams
- Supported migration of business-critical UI systems from Flex to Angular
- Influenced product roadmaps through backlog refinement, technical planning, and cross-functional coordination
- Managed knowledge transfer between engineering teams in Mexico and Dublin
- Mentored engineering teams while supporting Agile delivery practices and execution

Technologies: Java, Apache Spark, SQL, Pro*C, Oracle Database, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Angular, TypeScript, GoJS, AWS

Key Engineering Initiatives

Unified Pricing Engine — Kroger

- Validated Drools as a viable engine for enterprise pricing modernization through a successful proof of concept
- Translated legacy pricing logic into configurable, spreadsheet-driven rule definitions
- Implemented backend simulations to validate pricing workflows and rule execution consistency

Digital Wallet Platform — Bank of Jamaica

- Built foundational backend services for a regulated fintech platform supporting secure remittances and CBDC-related transactions
- Developed distributed event-driven workflows to ensure secure, reliable financial operations and customer verification flows

Collections & Recoveries Modernization — Equifax

- Transitioned high-volume financial batch workflows from legacy Pro*C to distributed Java and Spark processing
- Preserved functional continuity for global operations while enabling platform modernization and long-term scalability

Additional Strengths

- **Technical Leadership:** Experience leading and mentoring engineers through hands-on development and technical guidance
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Strong collaboration across engineering, product, QA, analytics, and architecture stakeholders
- **Reliability & Operational Integrity:** Focused on building reliable, observable systems with strong validation, traceability, and operational consistency
- **Modernization Mindset:** Experience evolving legacy enterprise platforms into scalable distributed systems
- **Domain Expertise:** Fintech, payments, pricing systems, digital identity, compliance-sensitive workflows, and enterprise AI solutions

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Applied Mathematics — Numerical Methods & Artificial Intelligence

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)

Diploma in Information Technologies Project Management

Tecnológico de Monterrey